

2. Continuous random variables

What students need to learn:

The concept of a continuous random variable.

The probability density function and the cumulative distribution function for a continuous random variable.

Use of the probability density function $f(x)$, where

$$P(a < X \leq b) = \int_a^b f(x) dx.$$

Use of the cumulative distribution function

$$F(x_0) = P(X \leq x_0) = \int_{-\infty}^{x_0} f(x) dx.$$

The formulae used in defining $f(x)$ will be restricted to simple polynomials which may be expressed piecewise.

Relationship between density and distribution functions.

$$f(x) = \frac{dF(x)}{dx}.$$

Mean and variance of continuous random variables.

Knowledge and use of

$$E(aX + b) = aE(X) + b$$

$$\text{Var}(aX + b) = a^2 \text{Var}(X)$$

Mode, median and quartiles of continuous random variables.
